

Case Study: Rainbow Lens — 101 Film Scripts in 25 Days on a ₹10,000 Budget

At a glance

For Pride Circle's Rainbow Lens film festival, I ran a 25-day Meta Ads campaign that brought in 101 film script submissions on a total budget of ₹10,000, for a new page with no existing credibility. The campaign worked by pairing video and static ads with a manual, human-led DM conversation instead of automation.

Metric	Result
Scripts received	101
Campaign duration	25 days
Budget	₹10,000 (about ₹99 per script at most)
Prize on offer	₹4,00,000 grant to make the winning film
Channels	Meta Ads (Facebook and Instagram)

- **Client:** Pride Circle
- **Event:** Rainbow Lens, a film festival seeking LGBT+ representation scripts
- **My role:** Campaign strategy, ad creative, and manual community management in DMs
- **Audience:** Young filmmakers and scriptwriters, from the LGBT+ community and beyond

The challenge

Rainbow Lens invited scripts, not just sign-ups. The winning script would receive a ₹4,00,000 grant to be made into a film, so the ask was a serious creative commitment. Three things made it hard:

- **A very small budget.** Only ₹10,000 to find writers and filmmakers across India.
- **A specific brief.** Scripts had to have a corporate-focused storyline and include a real-life LGBT+ person, which is a narrower pool than "any short film."
- **A brand-new page.** The Rainbow Lens page had no history, so there was no trust to lean on. People were being asked to hand over original work to an account they had never heard of.

The approach: Message first, answered by a human

I ran video and static ads that asked people to send us a DM rather than going straight to a form. Then I answered every query myself, by hand.

This was a deliberate choice. Automation works well for simple questions, and I use it on other campaigns. Here it would have failed, because writers had detailed, in-depth questions: what "corporate-focused" really meant, how a real-life LGBTQ+ person should be portrayed, what was and wasn't eligible, and how the grant would work. A scripted reply could not handle these, and a poor answer would have lost the script.

The manual approach also did a second job. For a new page, a real person answering thoughtfully built credibility quickly. It showed that the festival was genuine and that someone was behind it.

The submission flow

The Google Form that candidates had to fill included uploading the full script. That is a heavy ask, so most people held off until they were ready, which shaped how the campaign played out.

1. The ad prompted a DM.
2. I answered questions and cleared doubts one on one.
3. Once confident, the writer completed the Google Form and uploaded the script.

Results

101 scripts in 25 days on a ₹10,000 budget.

A large share of submissions arrived in the **last two days**. By then, queries had been cleared and writers had finished and polished their scripts. The surge came after the support work, not in spite of it. Hesitant writers needed their doubts resolved first, and the deadline gave them the push to submit.

Key learnings

1. **Match the level of human effort to the ask.** A small sign-up can be automated. A script worth ₹4,00,000 needs a conversation.
2. **Manual replies build trust for new pages.** A personal answer did more for credibility than any ad copy could.
3. **Expect a deadline surge.** When the conversion step takes real work, like finishing and uploading a script, most submissions arrive near the close. Keep answering queries until the end.
4. **A narrow brief needs clear answers.** Detailed eligibility questions are a sign of serious interest, not a barrier.

5. **Small budgets can work on high-value asks** when the funnel puts a real person between the ad and the form.